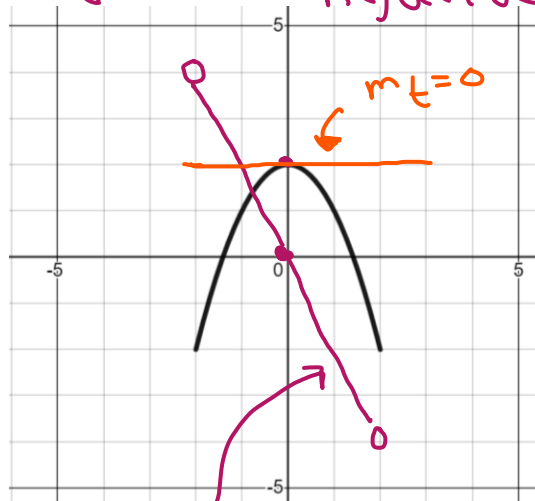


* parabola opens upward - slope is positive
 * " " downward - " " negative

* 1 3 5 step
 pattern $\Rightarrow$ slope = 2

* 2 6 10 step
 pattern $\Rightarrow$ slope = 4

* And so on...



step pattern = 1, 3, 5
 $\Rightarrow$ slope = -2

* parabola
 opens
 downward
 $\Rightarrow$ slope is
 negative

* A 1 3 5
 step pattern
 $\Rightarrow$ slope is 2

* A 2 6 10
 step pattern
 $\Rightarrow$ slope is 4

* And so on